

Ancient Indian History - Practice Set 02

RRB NTPC 2026 - History Syllabus Practice Series
Comprehensive Mixed Chapters Mock Test (10 Questions)

Question 1 — Topic: Prehistoric Period

In the archaeological sequence of Mehrgarh, Period I is characterized as an aceramic phase. What primary material evidence illuminates this layer?

- A) Extensive evidence of domesticated barley, wheat, and goat bones (Correct)
- B) Mature bronze metallurgy and drainage setups
- C) Iron slag and painted grey ware pottery
- D) Microliths linked exclusively to nomadic hunting camps

Explanation: Mehrgarh Period I provides crucial early evidence showing a transition toward plant cultivation and animal husbandry prior to pottery manufacturing.

Question 2 — Topic: Indus Valley Civilization

Dholavira deviates from typical bipartite Harappan layout configurations. What distinct structural feature characterizes its layout?

- A) It lacks fortification walls entirely
- B) A unique tripartite division with an intricate stone water reservoir system (Correct)
- C) Radial street structures rather than grids
- D) It functioned strictly as a burial ground with no public structures

Explanation: Dholavira features a unique three-part division (Citadel, Middle Town, Lower Town) along with massive stone water-harvesting systems.

Question 3 — Topic: Vedic Period

The legendary Videha Madhava narrative describing the eastward expansion of Vedic tribes across the Gandak River is detailed in which text?

- A) Aitareya Brahmana
- B) Shatapatha Brahmana (Correct)
- C) Taittiriya Samhita
- D) Mundaka Upanishad

Explanation: The Videha Madhava legend in the Shatapatha Brahmana allegorizes the expansion of Vedic culture and agrarian settlement into the middle Gangetic plains.

Question 4 — Topic: Religious Movements

According to the Jain doctrine of Syadvada and Anekantavada, what does the modal qualifier 'Syat' strictly signify?

- A) Conditioned assertion meaning 'from a certain perspective' (Correct)
- B) Absolute skepticism or denial of reality
- C) Complete suppression of the soul's karmic influx
- D) The transition into deep meditative trances

Explanation: Syadvada states that truth or reality is multifaceted, meaning any proposition is relative to a particular perspective ('Syat' = perhaps/in a certain respect).

Question 5 — Topic: Mahajanapadas

King Chanda Pradyota Mahasena, renowned for his fierce temper and war-elephants, was the monarch of which Mahajanapada?

- A) Matsya
- B) Avanti (Correct)
- C) Assaka
- D) Chedi

Explanation: Chanda Pradyota ruled the powerful central-western Mahajanapada of Avanti from his capital at Ujjain.

Question 6 — Topic: Mauryan Empire

In Kautilya's Arthashastra, what was the primary functional jurisdiction of the 'Kantakasodhana' courts?

- A) Civil property disputes and marriage contracts
- B) Criminal justice, administrative oversight, and anti-social suppression (Correct)
- C) Ecclesiastical judgements for heterodox ascetics
- D) Regulating maritime trade lanes and foreign policy codes

Explanation: Kantakasodhana courts (literally removal of thorns) functioned as criminal and administrative courts to check corruption and severe public offenses.

Question 7 — Topic: Post-Mauryan Period

The Rabatak inscription discovered in northern Afghanistan has been crucial for reconstructing the genealogy of which imperial dynasty?

- A) Indo-Greeks
- B) Kushanas (Correct)
- C) Western Satraps
- D) Guptas

Explanation: The Rabatak inscription provides critical linguistic and genealogical evidence clarifying the succession lines of the early Kushan emperors, including Kanishka.

Question 8 — Topic: Gupta Empire

In the administrative and land grant framework of the Gupta Empire, what does the term 'Vishti' denote?

- A) Irrigation cess on water wheels
- B) Forced or unremunerated labor exacted from the peasantry (Correct)
- C) Elite merchant guild tax paid in gold coins
- D) Religious offering given to Shaivite shrines

Explanation: *Vishti refers to forced, unpaid labor services exacted by the state or landlords, which grew increasingly common in late classical land grants.*

Question 9 — Topic: South Indian Dynasties

The historic Aihole Prasasti inscription, composed by the court poet Ravikirti, celebrates the military triumph of which Chalukyan king?

- A) Pulakeshin I
- B) Pulakeshin II (Correct)
- C) Vikramaditya I
- D) Kirtivarman I

Explanation: *The Aihole inscription commemorates the notable victory of Pulakeshin II over the northern emperor Harshavardhana along the Narmada River.*

Question 10 — Topic: Sangam Age

The classical Tamil grammatical treatise Tolkappiyam organizes landscapes into five Eco-zones (Tinaï). Which zone represents the coastal region?

- A) Kurinji
- B) Mullai
- C) Marutam
- D) Neytal (Correct)

Explanation: *Neytal represents the coastal maritime landscape, characterized primarily by fishing and salt manufacturing occupations.*